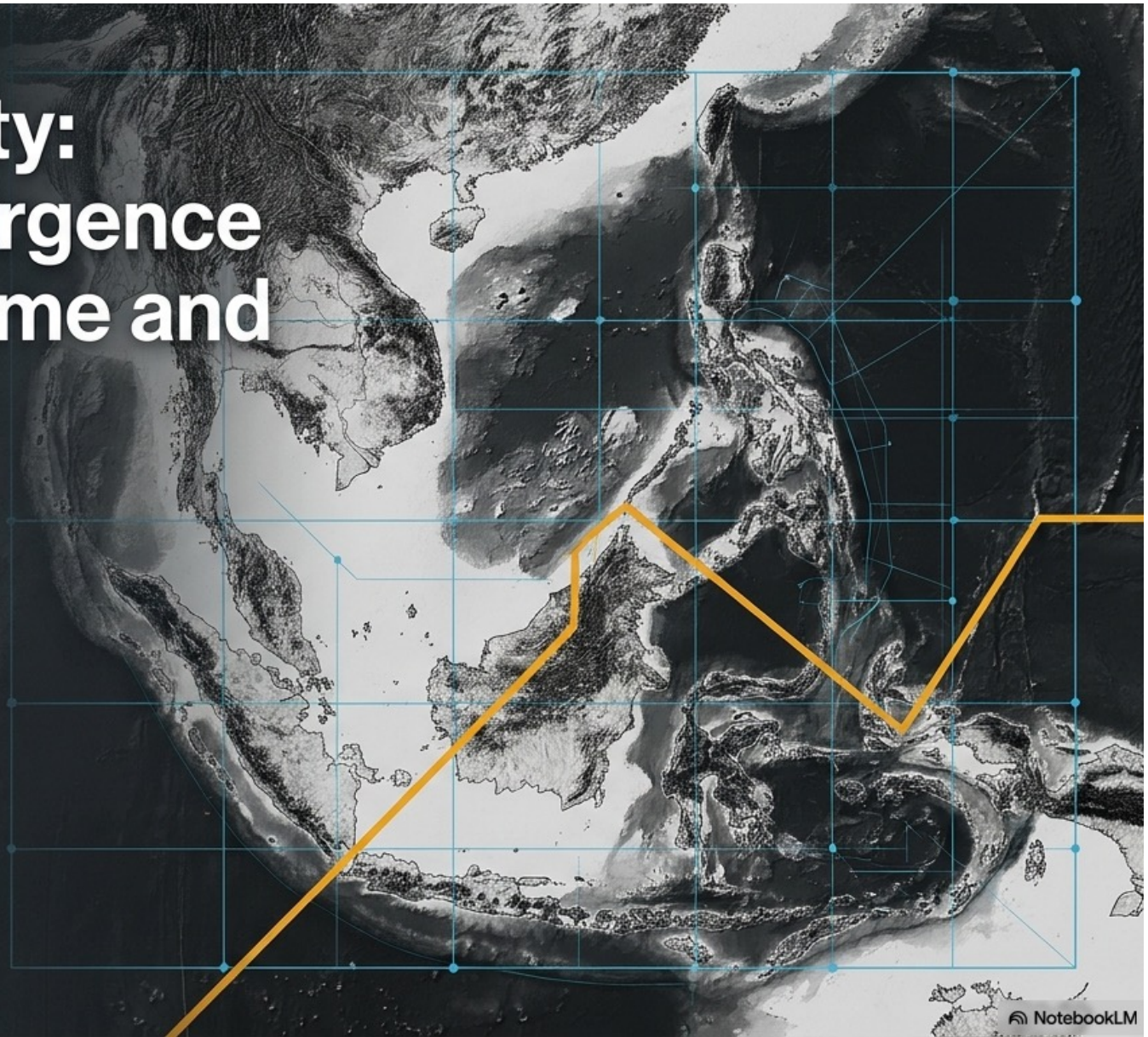


Hybrid Criminality: The 2026 Convergence of Organised Crime and Cyberterrorism

Topic 4 | Digital Crime
Investigation Course

Graduate-Level
Intelligence Briefing



The Paradigm Shift: Outdated Silos vs. Modern Realities

Last Year's Syllabus

1	Lone hackers & isolated, computer-native syndicates	
2	Ransomware focused strictly on data encryption.	
3	Ideological groups relying on personal donations (Hawala).	

The 2026 Reality

State proxies, hybrid actors, and industrialised criminal enterprises.



Pure data exposure, double-extortion, and Ransomware-as-a-Service (RaaS).



Tactical partnerships with organised crime for funding via poly-criminality.



The Global Cybercrime Landscape

Key Insights from the Europol IOCTA 2026 Report

The Gen-AI Catalyst

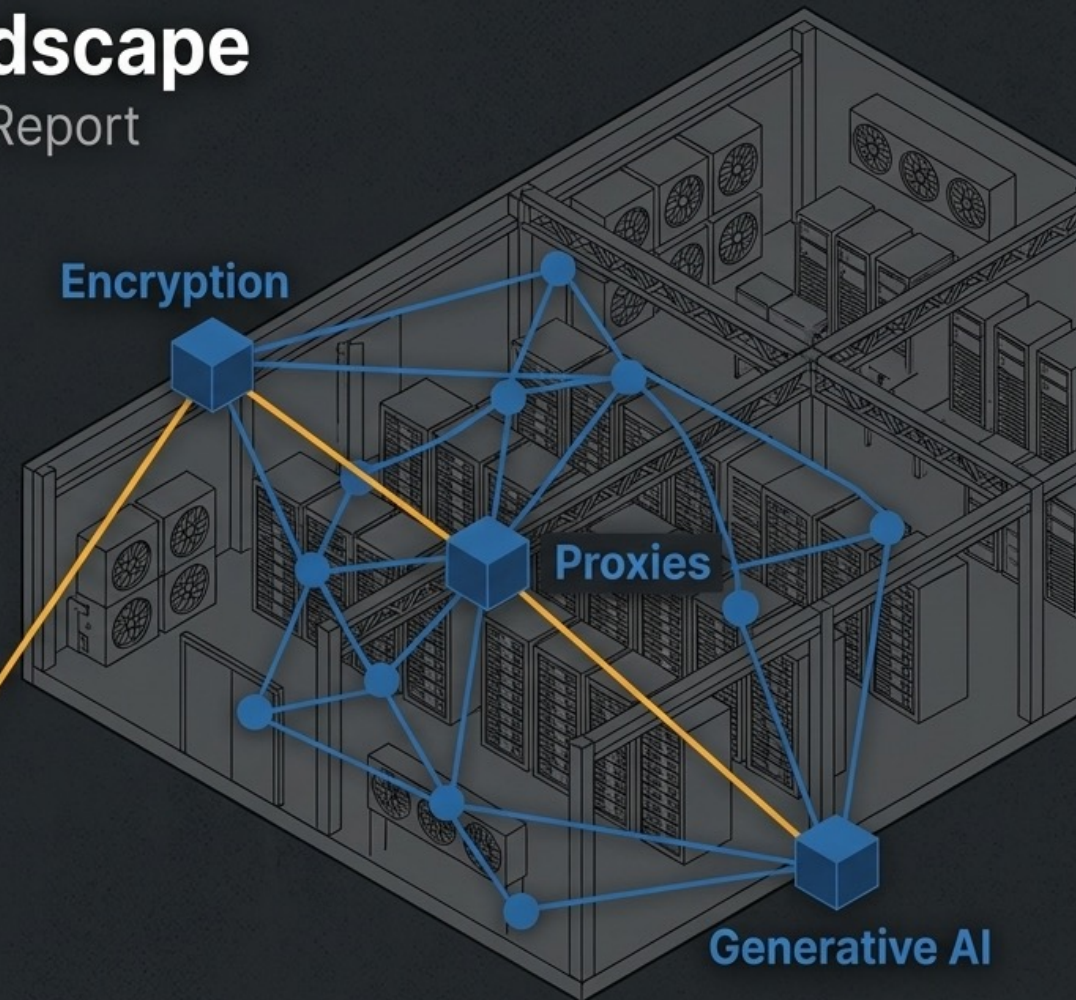
Artificial Intelligence, end-to-end encryption, and anonymising proxies have lowered technical barriers, driving the industrialisation of cybercrime.

The Hybrid Proxy

The line between nation-state actors and cybercriminals has dissolved. Hybrid threat actors now actively utilise cybercrime networks as operational proxies.

The Extortion Evolution

The ransomware model has aggressively pivoted from traditional data encryption to pure data theft and extortion via public data exposure.



The Regional Threat Iceberg

INTERPOL 2025/2026 Asia and South Pacific Assessment

Reported Incidents

135,000 recorded ransomware attacks in 2024.

5.5 out of 1,000 individuals clicking phishing links monthly (2x global average).

The Systemic Shift

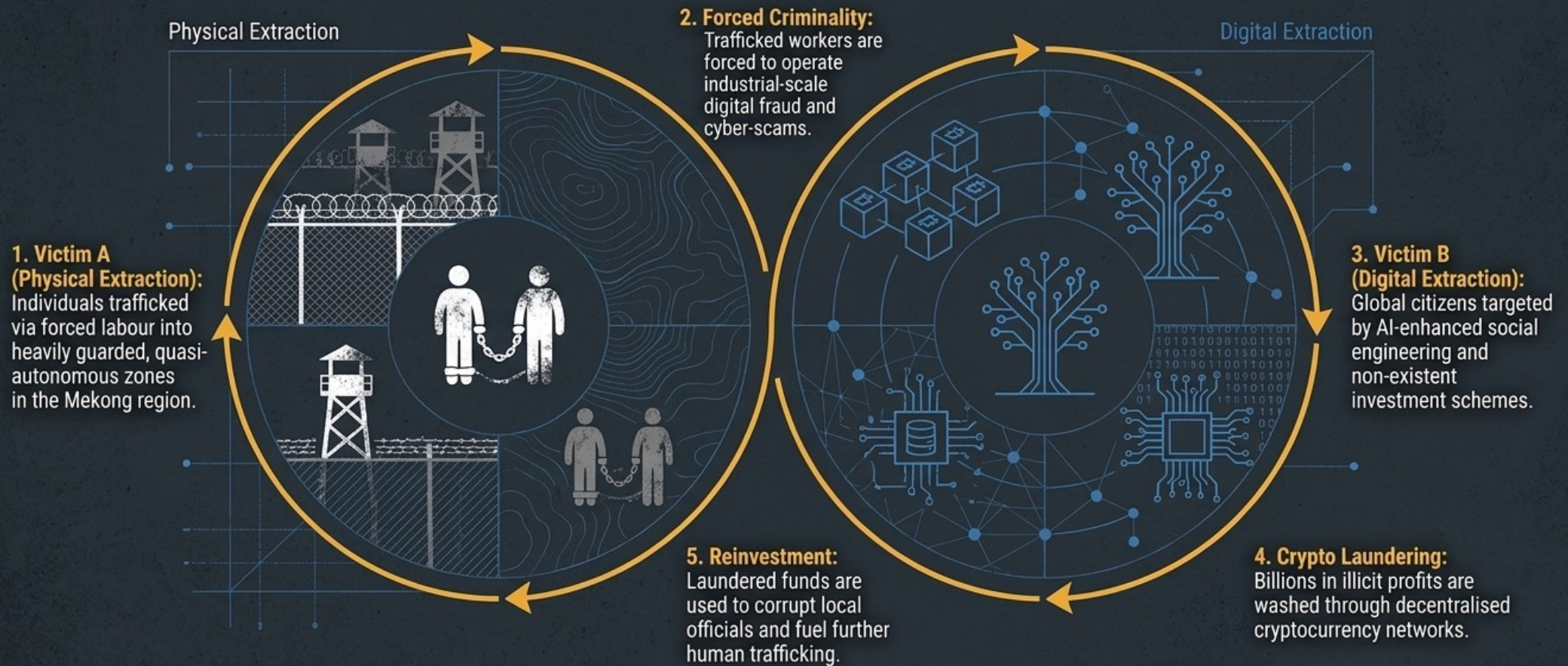
Cybercrime now accounts for over 30% of all recorded national crime in half of the surveyed countries.

600% Surge: The increase in deepfake discussions on Southeast Asian cybercriminal Telegram forums (Feb-June 2024), marking the rapid professionalisation of AI-driven fraud.



The 'Compound Crime' Ecosystem

The Poly-Criminality of Southeast Asian Scam Farms (GI-TOC / ASEAN-ACT 2025)



Malaysia's Hybrid Organised Crime Threat

Criminologist Insights (P. Sundramoorthy, 2026)

Coercive Criminality

Cybercrime has evolved from isolated fraud into franchise-like transnational networks. Double-extortion **ransomware** now overlaps with intimidation, physical threats, and national security risks.

Enforcement Action

Large-scale raids (Op Taring, Op Belatuk, Op Frontier) have uncovered highly structured syndicates operating from fortified residential and commercial premises.

Legislative Evolution

The urgent transition from the outdated Computer Crimes Act 1997 to the proposed Cybercrime Bill, designed to tackle AI-enabled scams and organised cyber syndicates.



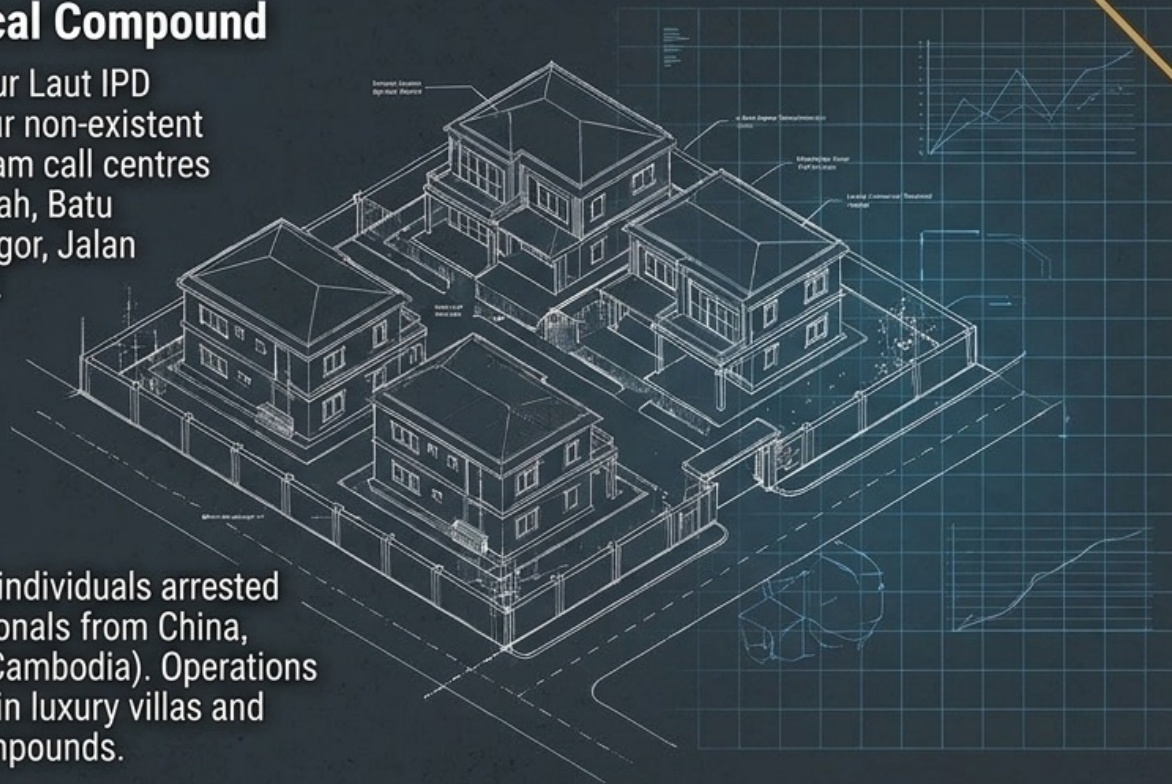
Tactical Case Study: July 2026 Penang Raids

The physical reality of the 'Dual-Victim' phenomenon

The Physical Compound

The Bust: Timur Laut IPD dismantled four non-existent investment scam call centres (Tanjung Bungah, Batu Ferringhi, Gelugor, Jalan Sungai Kelian).

The Scale: 80 individuals arrested (including nationals from China, Vietnam, and Cambodia). Operations disguised within luxury villas and residential compounds.



The Digital Timeline

The Rescue: A 25-year-old Cameroonian woman was rescued in Bukit Mertajam.

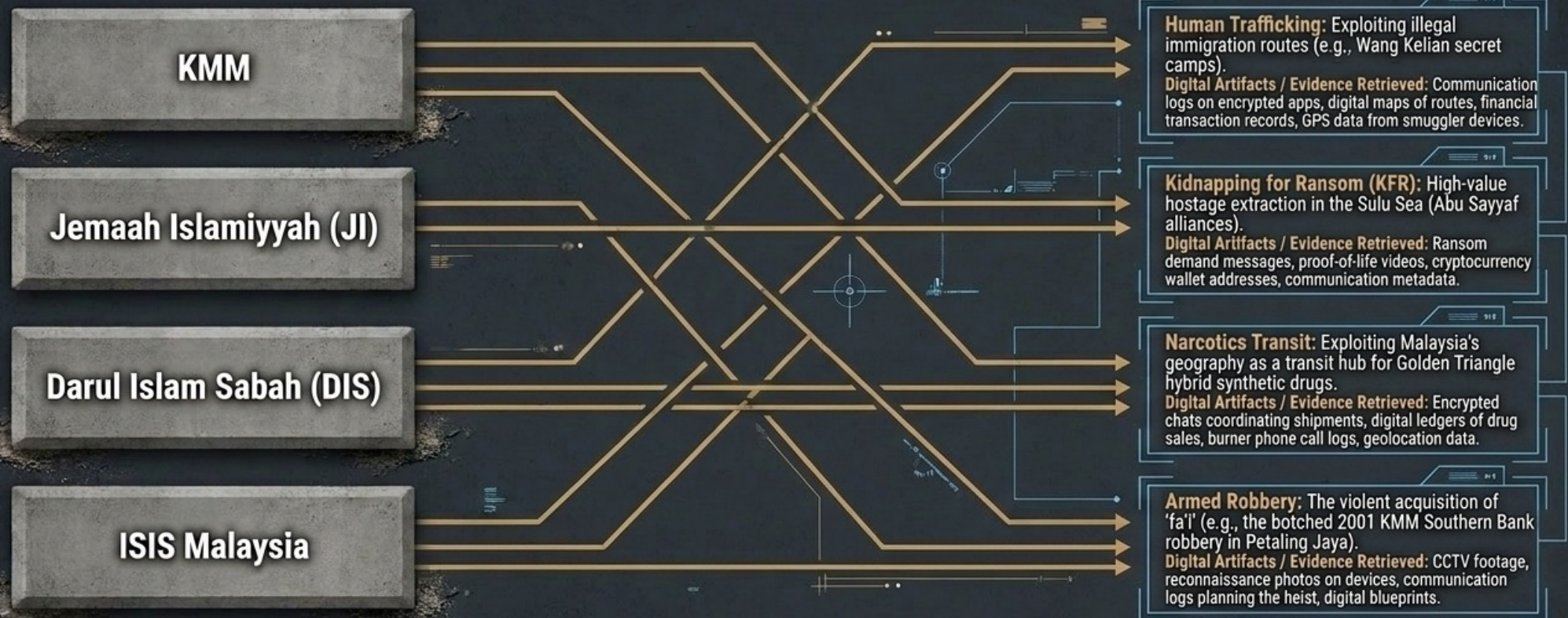
Deceived by a job offer.

Trafficked from Cambodia via illegal routes.

Held captive for a year with her passport withheld and wages denied.

The Crime-Terror Nexus

Tactical Partnerships for Funding (Al-Tamaddun 2020 Study)



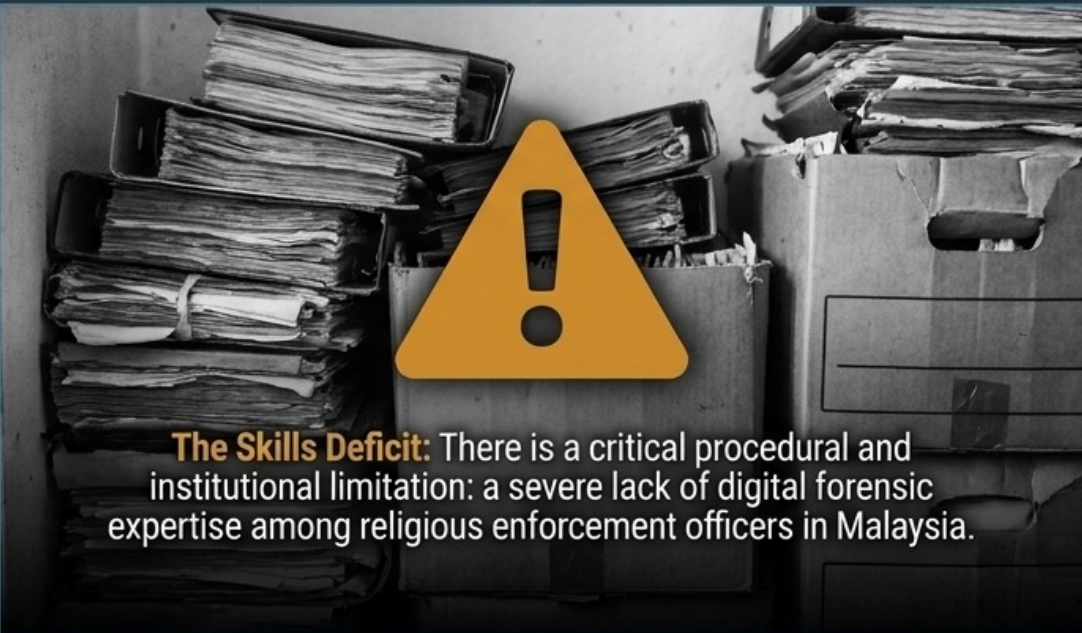
Digital Forensics as Qarinah Muasirah

Proving Cyber Offences under Islamic Evidence Law (Al-Istinbath 2026)



The Institutional Implementation Gap

Addressing the reality of Syariah Court Practice Directions



The Future Requirement: To successfully prosecute modern, hybrid cyber-offences (like online al-maysir and AI-driven fraud), enforcement bodies must rapidly upskill in cryptographic tracking, data preservation, and digital attribution.

Bibliography & Scholarly References

Europol IOCTA (2026). The evolving threat landscape: how encryption, proxies and AI are expanding cybercrime.

INTERPOL (2026). Asia and South Pacific Cyberthreat Assessment Report 2025/2026.

GI-TOC / ASEAN-ACT (2025). Compound Crime: Cyber Scam Operations in Southeast Asia.

Sundramoorthy, P. (2026). Malaysia's emerging hybrid organised crime threat. FMT.

Tuan Ibrahim, T. M. F. H., et al. (2026). The Role of Digital Forensics as Qarinah Muasirah in Proving Cyber Offences Under Malaysian Islamic Evidence Law. *Al-Istinbath: Jurnal Hukum Islam*, 11(1). (Scopus)

Universiti Malaya / JIER (2024/2025). Cybercrime in Contemporary Society & The Crime-Terror Nexus.

UiTM Journal (2026). Factors Influencing the Adoption of Digital Forensic in Malaysian Organisation. (Scopus)